SHARON ESPINOZA

espinoza.s@pucp.edu.pe +51 978 169 688 sharonespinoza.com sharonespinoza20

EDUCATION

PONTIFICIA UNIVERSIDAD CATÓLICA DEL PERÚ (PUCP)
Bachelor's Degree in Economics
Relevant Coursework: Linear Algebra (Graduate level), Econometrics, Microeconomics II 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

WYSS ACADEMY FOR NATURE **DATA ANALYSIS CONSULTANT**
Aug. 2025 – Jul. 2026

Narratives and Technology Adoption in Artisanal Gold Mining
PIs: Kai Gehring, PhD (University of Bern), Fernando Fernandez, PhD (University of Bern), Arne Weiss, PhD (University of Alicante)

Led data analysis for a multi-arm RCT examining how narrative-based interventions affect technology adoption and willingness to pay (WTP) among artisanal gold miners in Madre de Dios, Peru, coordinating directly with the principal investigators. Built, cleaned, and merged the study dataset across treatment arms and survey rounds; updated the survey instrument and constructed outcome indicators, including a narrative-based self-perception measure. Estimated treatment effects and conducted balance and heterogeneity analyses, and delivered a draft report with regression tables and coefficient plots ahead of contract close.

INNOVATIONS FOR POVERTY ACTION (IPA) – PERU **RESEARCH ASSOCIATE**
Jan. 2022 – Present

- *Can Smartphone Applications Help Caregivers Improve Early Childhood Development in Peru? (VOLAR)* Peru, Jul. 2024 – Present
  PIs: Orazio Attanasio, PhD (Yale), Matthew Bird, PhD & Pablo Lavado, PhD (Universidad del Pacífico)
- *Evaluation Doodle Learning* Belize, Feb. – Jul. 2025
  PIs: Emma Näslund-Hadley, MPA (IDB), Juan Agramonte
- *Play for the Mangroves: Environmental Behavior and Conservation* Dominican Republic, Nov. 2023 – Jun. 2024
  PIs: Jennifer Alix-Garcia, PhD (Oregon State University), Christopher Knittel, PhD (MIT)
- *Migration and Labor Markets: Firm Hiring Practices* Ecuador, Sep. – Oct. 2023
  PI: Cynthia Van Der Werf, PhD (IDB)
- *Microfinance Plus: Credit Access and Business Development* Paraguay, Mar. – Aug. 2023
  PIs: Nathan Fiala, PhD (University of Connecticut), Lise Masselus, MSc (RWI)
- *Safer Municipalities in Honduras* Honduras, 2022
  PIs: Laura Chioda, PhD (UC Berkeley), Marcus Holmlund, MA (World Bank), Benjamin Feigenberg, PhD (University of Illinois Chicago)

Description

- Led field data collection with teams of up to 48 staff, directing large samples across multiple departments and regions simultaneously, including complex zones that required coordination with local authorities and community leaders.
- Worked with hard-to-access populations, leading tracking and recontact strategies to minimize attrition, and coordinating with government, private, and implementing partners and multiple principal investigators across each evaluation.
- Conducted power calculations and sampling designs ahead of each evaluation, programmed surveys, adapted questionnaires, and managed data collection instruments, including behavioral tools to measure perceptions, beliefs, and WTP.
- Led data quality processes during fieldwork through in-person monitoring, phone-based monitoring, and field audits.
- Applied causal inference methods suited to experimental and quasi-experimental designs, including treatment effect estimation and heterogeneity analysis; built a scraper to bulk-extract publicly available administrative records from government and non-government portals; and conducted record linkage and fuzzy matching across heterogeneous data sources to consolidate longitudinal panels using Python, R, and Stata.
- Produced data collection and monitoring reports, maintained constant communication with field and research teams on progress, and led multi-stakeholder meetings with principal investigators, donors, and government and community counterparts.

In 2025, also provided temporary support to project development, assessing the feasibility of new research initiatives with the Country Director and Country Manager as well as developing funding proposals for institutional partners.

PONTIFICIA UNIVERSIDAD CATÓLICA DEL PERÚ **RESEARCH ASSISTANT**

Oct. 2020 – Nov. 2021

- Research assistant to Professor Mario Tello Pacheco, PhD.

RESEARCH

- Microeconomic Determinants of Peruvian Firms' Participation in Global Value Chains
  Sharon Espinoza & Rodrigo Silupú *Undergraduate Thesis, PUCP, 2022*

Research Contributions (acknowledged)

- COVID-19 Spillover Effects on Poverty in Peru: A Non-Experimental Synthetic Control Design
  Mario Tello Pacheco *Working Paper – PUCP, 2023*
- Synthetic Controls and Dosage Strategy: An Exploratory Provincial Analysis of COVID-19 Effects on Income, Employment, and Poverty in Peru, 2011–2020
  Mario Tello Pacheco *CIES, 2021*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Applied Econometrics with Stata Aug. 2025 – Jul. 2026

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (PUCP) – Part-Time Lecturer

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

ProCiencia Research Grant 2021

Concytec
Secured competitive research funding for a bachelor's thesis project under the Applied Social Sciences Research Program.

Together for Development Scholarship 2019

United World College (UWC)
Partial summer scholarship for an intensive program on Development Theories, Institutional Corruption, and Sustainability in Mbabane, Eswatini.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Data Analysis for Social Scientists 2026 – Present

MITx

Behavioral Economics Course – APE 2026 Continuing Education Program 2026

Asociación Peruana de Economía (APE), CIES, Universidad del Pacífico & LACEA-BRAIN
Awarded a full scholarship.

Introduction to Machine Learning for Public Policy 2024

CIES & Universidad Peruana de Ciencias Aplicadas (UPC)
Applied machine learning techniques for policy evaluation.

Winter School in Advanced Methods for Social Sciences 2024

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú & Q-Lab
Selected for this intensive program; coursework in Machine Learning & Causal Inference and Applied Data Science in Political Analysis.

Lima Summer School in Economics 2023

Universidad de Piura & Vancouver School of Economics
Full scholarship recipient; specialized in Machine Learning for Economics and Differences-in-Differences: New Methods & Applications.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Software
Python, Stata, R

Programming & Tools
LaTeX, SurveyCTO, Power BI, MS Office, Git

Languages
Spanish (native), English (fluent)

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Member of the Board of Directors, EconThaki — May 2025 – Present
Academic programs increasing diversity in Latin American economics academia.

Technical Influencer, Innovations for Poverty Action — 2023
Developed data collection tools adopted across IPA projects.

Director for Economics, Voces Violeta Organization — 2022 – 2023
Social organization preventing gender-based violence through psychological support and education.